Pre-Flight Checklist

For DJI Mini series drones (DJI Fly). Excerpted from the full Flight Standards document. See that page for the reasoning behind each item, naming conventions, and flight-planning guidance.

Before Flights

Gear

- ☐ Drone and controller batteries charged, plus spares. (3 total per drone).
- ☐ SD card in the drone with free space, and the previous outing's photos already offloaded.
- ☐ Propellers checked for chips or cracks.

Missions Built

- ☐ A full flight set exists for each road section. One at ~70 ft and one at ~200 ft. See Flight Paths.
- ☐ Gimbal pitch matches the height for that flight. See Heights and Angles.
- ☐ Every mission is **under 90 photos**.
- ☐ Paths run along the road shoulder, not over the traveled way or private property.
- ☐ Missions are named according to the mission naming convention.
- ☐ Airspace checked with **Show FAA Airspace Restrictions** in the Creator, and LAANC filed if the ceiling requires it.

> **!** Important
>
> LAANC cannot be submitted from the Flight Planner — you have to file it in another app before you fly.

Transferred to the Controller

- ☐ Controller powered on and connected to the computer by USB.
- ☐ Preview (Mac), Android File Transfer, and any other MTP tools are **closed**. Won't work if they are open.
- ☐ Missions pushed with the DJI Fly Transfer tab. See Uploading.
- ☐ Load each mission on the controller, back out to the mission history page, and press save.
- ☐ Missions confirmed against the checklist at the bottom of the DJI Fly Transfer tab.

! Important

The controller shows missions as long random strings (on app) or date/time (on controller), not names. The thumbnail is the only practical way to tell them apart in the field, and it does not update on its own. If you skip the refresh you will not know which mission is which.

On Site Before Takeoff

Drone Check

- ☐ Insert a charged battery and confirm it clicks/locks in place
- ☐ Battery is securely in its slot. If it is not, it may slide out in the air.
- ☐ Daylight, clear visibility, wind within the aircraft's limits.
- ☐ Note any potential obstacles or things that may interfere with the flight plan.
- ☐ No bystanders under the flight path.
- ☐ Correct mission selected — check the thumbnail.
- ☐ **Take off as close as possible to the first waypoint.**

Start Up Check

- ☐ Power on the RC first, then power on the drone
- ☐ Open flight app and confirm live video feed is active
- ☐ Wait for GPS lock — confirm satellite count is 8 or higher
- ☐ Check compass and IMU calibration status — recalibrate if prompted
- ☐ Set Return-to-Home altitude above the tallest obstacle in the flight path
- ☐ Check RC signal strength and confirm controls are responding
- ☐ Arm motors briefly to confirm all props spin freely and evenly
- ☐ Do a low 6-foot hover for 10–15 seconds to check stability before flying out

! Important

Waypoint altitudes are relative to wherever the drone takes off, not to the mission or to sea level. Launching from a spot noticeably higher or lower than the first waypoint shifts the whole flight up or down by that difference.

Between Flights

- ☐ Keep at least **30 seconds** between flights. The Photo Sorter splits flights on time gaps, so back-to-back flights get merged into one folder.
- ☐ Keep a record of the order you fly the missions in. It makes naming the groups in the Photo Sorter much faster afterwards.

After Flights

- ☐ Photos pulled off and split with the Photo Sorter.
- ☐ Folders named after their mission. See Photo Folders.
- ☐ Missions uploaded to Box so the flight tracker picks them up. See Flight Tracker.
- ☐ Photos uploaded to Box folder.